MAIN STREET IQ
Financial IQ for Main Street

Wine Country Intelligence

Monitor Plus

Brimova Cellars

October 2026 report. AI answers collected October 10, 2026 to November 3, 2026; site and listings read November 2, 2026.

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> Illustrative sample. The winery, its peers and every figure below are invented to show the format of a monthly Monitor Plus report. They do not describe or predict any winery's results.

This month at a glance

Brimova Cellars is fourth of the five wineries in your group. The first gap to close this month is Yelp review count, where you have 148 and Aurelda Family Wines has 338.

41.9	4 of 5	86	5%
overall score, of 100	rank in your peer set	in Santa Barbara County, of 169 ranked	of Santa Barbara County AI answers name you (75 of 1,532)

Three moves this month

1. Close the gap on Yelp review count.

Your third-largest gap to the peer set once weighted by its strong link to AI naming.

2. Get onto a wine tour company's site.

Best small-production wineries in Santa Barbara County: the sources cited for this question point here, and you are named in 0 of 21 answers (0%).

3. Close the gap on reviews in the last 90 days.

Your fourth-largest gap to the peer set once weighted by its strong link to AI naming.

A note from Scott Hess

The one thing I would put first this month: Yelp review count, where Aurelda Family Wines leads the wineries you asked me to watch. Across every winery we measure, it is one of the things that go most closely with being named by AI assistants.

Overall you scored 41.9 of 100, fourth of the five wineries in your group, and 86th of 169 in Santa Barbara County. Against your group, you come closest to the leader in AI-Ready Booking & Buying. Against the best in your group, and for the size of each category, your widest gap is in Third-Party Presence, where you have 6.0 of 23 points and Dagena Family Wines has 12.5.

We moved a few points between measures this month, so this score is not set beside last month's; What changed in the scoring, after Drift Watch, lists what moved.

The section on where the points are has the detail on Yelp review count, and two more moves.

Scott Hess

You and your peer set

Winery	Overall	Third-Party Presence (23)	Review Volume & Reputation (23)	Search & Map Discovery (21)	AI-Ready Booking & Buying (14)	Profile Accuracy (6)	Citation Readiness (8)	Social (5)	Named in AI answers
Brimova Cellars	41.9	6.0	8.2	4.0	10.0	3.8	6.8	3.1	75 of 1,532
Aurelda Family Wines	48.9	9.2	11.4	5.0	11.0	4.3	5.2	2.8	66 of 1,532
Bentova Cellars	39.4	7.2	4.1	6.0	10.0	4.8	4.5	2.8	28 of 1,532
Brugello Estate	51.5	12.0	13.1	8.0	8.0	4.3	5.0	1.1	57 of 1,532
Dagena Family Wines	49.6	12.5	7.5	4.0	10.0	3.8	7.5	4.2	80 of 1,532

A small scoring change this month. The seven categories are the same as in your September 2026 report, but we moved a few points between measures. So this month's score is not set beside last month's; the score comparison starts with next month's report. What changed is listed after Drift Watch.

Since last month

September 2026 against October 2026: you, your peers and every winery in Santa Barbara County.

Measure	September 2026	October 2026	Your change	Your peers	Santa Barbara County
Google reviews	51	51	no change	typical +0.5	typical no change; 71 of 164 rose
Google rating	4.7	4.7	no change	typical no change	typical no change; 8 of 164 rose
Extra categories listed	0	0	no change	typical no change	typical no change; 1 of 164 rose
Profile checks in place	4 of 6	4 of 6	no change	0 of 4 changed	3 of 164 changed

Of your peers, Brugello Estate and Dagena Family Wines added more Google reviews than you did.

Drift Watch

What we watch	This month	What moved
Search and AI visibility	Checked, nothing moved against you	Nothing in the Google Maps searches we track; no alert rule for AI answers yet.
Reputation	Checked, nothing moved against you	Nothing
Reach to search and AI crawlers	Checked, nothing moved against you	Nothing
Structured data on your site	Checked, nothing moved against you	Nothing
Social posting	Checked, nothing moved against you	Nothing

Peer movement: not compared this month, because points moved between measures; What changed in the scoring, below, lists what moved.

What changed in the scoring

The seven categories and the 100-point total are the same as in your September 2026 report. Reweighted: Google review count and Online reservations now count for less. New to the score: Bookable through an AI-connected platform and Site modernity. Two categories changed size: Review Volume & Reputation is now 23 points and Citation Readiness is now 8 points.

The 7 categories, one by one

Third-Party Presence (23 points)

You scored 6.0 of 23. Your peer set ranged from 6.0 to 12.5, led by Dagena Family Wines. Where you trail the peer set: Named on best-of lists (you 29% of the full mark, Brugello Estate 71% of the full mark); Editorial and press mentions (you 0, Dagena Family Wines 2); Regional tourism and trade directories (you 50%, Aurelda Family Wines and Dagena Family Wines 100%).

Review Volume & Reputation (23 points)

You scored 8.2 of 23. Your peer set ranged from 4.1 to 13.1, led by Brugello Estate. Where you trail the peer set: Reviews in the last 90 days and Yelp review count, both among this month's moves (figures under Where the points are); Google review count (you 51, Brugello Estate 177).

Search & Map Discovery (21 points)

You scored 4.0 of 21. Your peer set ranged from 4.0 to 8.0, led by Brugello Estate. Where you trail the peer set: Map-pack presence (you 0%, Brugello Estate 23%); Owns its brand search (Bentova Cellars has it and you do not).

AI-Ready Booking & Buying (14 points)

You scored 10.0 of 14. Your peer set ranged from 8.0 to 11.0, led by Aurelda Family Wines. Where you trail the peer set: Tasting fee published on a tasting page (Aurelda Family Wines and Bentova Cellars have it and you do not).

Profile Accuracy (6 points)

You scored 3.8 of 6. Your peer set ranged from 3.8 to 4.8, led by Bentova Cellars. Where you trail the peer set: Google secondary categories (you 0, Bentova Cellars 3).

Citation Readiness (8 points)

You scored 6.8 of 8. Your peer set ranged from 4.5 to 7.5, led by Dagena Family Wines. Where you trail the peer set: Store prices readable without JavaScript (Dagena Family Wines has it and you do not); Tasting notes (Dagena Family Wines has it and you do not).

Social (5 points)

You scored 3.1 of 5. Your peer set ranged from 1.1 to 4.2, led by Dagena Family Wines. Where you trail the peer set: Instagram followers (you 1,937, Dagena Family Wines 13,501).

Your AI questions

Each of your 15 questions was asked of 7 AI assistants in 3 rounds between October 10, 2026 and November 3, 2026. ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Google AI Mode, Microsoft Copilot and Perplexity answered all 45; Google AI Overviews answered 38 of 45 (Google showed no AI Overview for 7 of the searches).

Who and what each assistant shows

Assistant	Answers	Named you	Wineries it names most	Sources it cites most
ChatGPT	45	1 of 45	Kelvane Family Wines 19; Becane Family Wines 16; Dribory Estate 15	a regional wine association site 15; a regional visitor guide 15; a wine blog 10
Claude	45	4 of 45	Becane Family Wines 20; Sundova Vineyards 16; Driltino Cellars 15	a wine travel blog 16; a regional visitor guide 14; tripadvisor.com 13
Gemini	45	1 of 45	Becane Family Wines 22; Lendette Cellars 22; Kelvane Family Wines 18	a regional visitor guide 16; a wine-tasting shuttle service's site 13; a regional wine association site 9
Google AI Mode	45	1 of 45	Zantera Estate 15; Becane Family Wines 13; Kelvane Family Wines 8	becanefamilywines.com 7; noporywinecompany.com 6; a travel review site 6
Google AI Overviews	38	0 of 38	Becane Family Wines 15; Driltino Cellars 10; Legory Winery 10	a regional wine association site 6; a regional visitor guide 6; a wine-tasting shuttle service's site 6
Microsoft Copilot	45	1 of 45	Larkhollow Family Wines 20; Boldona Cellars 17; Kelvane Family Wines 17	a wine club review site 18; a national wine magazine 17; tripadvisor.com 17
Perplexity	45	3 of 45	Becane Family Wines 17; Kelvane Family Wines 14; Sundova Vineyards 14	a regional visitor guide 16; a regional wine association site 10; a wine club review site 8

Reach: more people hear of you

Question	Named you	Assistants naming you	Named instead (answers)
Where to taste Pinot Noir in Santa Barbara County (priority)	0 of 21 (0%)	none	Lendette Cellars 18; Sundova Vineyards 17; Trovory Cellars 14 (of 21)
Most highly rated wineries in Santa Barbara County	3 of 21 (14%)	Claude 1 of 3; Microsoft Copilot 1 of 3; Google AI Mode 1 of 3	Pontena Vineyards 17; Sundova Vineyards 16; Kelvane Family Wines 13 (of 21)
Best small-production wineries in Santa Barbara County (priority)	0 of 21 (0%)	none	Braldello Vineyards 14; Vuldeau Wine Co. 10; Nalveau Estate 9 (of 21)
Santa Barbara County wineries that farm organically	0 of 20 (0%)	none	Driseau Wine Co. 17; Rilona Family Wines 17; Vusello Estate 17 (of 20)
Best Chardonnay producers in Santa Barbara County	0 of 20 (0%)	none	Pontena Vineyards 17; Lendette Cellars 14; Sundova Vineyards 14 (of 20)

Visit: more people in the tasting room

Question	Named you	Assistants naming you	Named instead (answers)
Best tasting rooms in the Lompoc Wine Ghetto (priority)	0 of 21 (0%)	none	Vimino Family Wines 18; Tiltara Winery 15; Vusello Estate 13 (of 21)
Best wineries for a day trip to Santa Barbara wine country (priority)	2 of 21 (10%)	Claude 1 of 3; Perplexity 1 of 3	Becane Family Wines 14; Quilvara Estate 14; Vicova Vineyards 10 (of 21)
Dog-friendly wineries in Santa Barbara wine country	2 of 20 (10%)	ChatGPT 1 of 3; Gemini 1 of 3	Gumona Estate 15; Boldona Cellars 14; Broltory Cellars 14 (of 20)
Wineries with food pairings in Santa Barbara County	1 of 20 (5%)	Perplexity 1 of 3	Lopello Estate 14; Marlessa Estate 11; Legory Winery 10 (of 20)
Wineries with live music in Santa Ynez Valley	0 of 21 (0%)	none	Tibena Family Wines 16; Becane Family Wines 14; Merrisa Cellars 14 (of 21)
Beginner-friendly wineries in Santa Barbara County	0 of 20 (0%)	none	Oscalla Winery 13; Kelvane Family Wines 11; Becane Family Wines 10 (of 20)

Buy: club, allocation and sales

Question	Named you	Assistants naming you	Named instead (answers)
Santa Barbara County wineries that welcome groups	0 of 21 (0%)	none	Nopory Wine Co. 16; Lopello Estate 14; Becane Family Wines 13 (of 21)
Best high-end seated tastings in Santa Barbara County (priority)	1 of 20 (5%)	Perplexity 1 of 3	Kelmorra Cellars 15; Zantera Estate 9; Nupena Family Wines 8 (of 20)
Santa Barbara County wineries worth booking ahead	2 of 21 (10%)	Claude 2 of 3	Toltello Family Wines 12; Becane Family Wines 11; Driltino Cellars 9 (of 21)
Romantic wineries for a special occasion in Santa Barbara County	0 of 20 (0%)	none	Becane Family Wines 19; Driltino Cellars 10; Kelvane Family Wines 8 (of 20)

Questions worded away from you

Two of your questions appear to favor other wineries by how they are worded, so on these a low count may say as much about the question as about you. If you offer what one of these questions asks for, tell us and we add it to your file; if a question names a place you do not want to be found for, we can reword it for next month.

Wineries with food pairings in Santa Barbara County. You were named in 1 of 20 answers (5%). It asks about food, which is not among the offers we have on file for you. Lopello Estate was named in 14 of 20 answers (70%).

Wineries with live music in Santa Ynez Valley. You were named in 0 of 21 answers (0%). The question names Santa Ynez Valley, where Tibena Family Wines, named in 16 of 21 answers (76%), has its tasting room; yours is in Lompoc.

The citation gap: what the assistants cited instead

Best high-end seated tastings in Santa Barbara County (priority): 19 answers named other wineries and not you. Cited most in them: a regional visitor guide (6 of 19); zanteraestate.com, the Zantera Estate site (6 of 19); legorywinery.com, the Legory Winery site (5 of 19); a national wine magazine (5 of 19). None of those 19 cited your site or a page with your name in its address.

In 8 of those answers the assistant showed what its search returned, and your site was not among the results in any of them. The assistants searched for “top high-end seated tastings in santa barbara county”, “santa barbara county high-end seated tastings recommendations” and “top high-end seated tastings in santa barbara county guide”; being found for those terms comes before anything on the page. Google's AI answers cited another winery's Google Business Profile in 3 of the 5 Google answers here that named others, and yours in none of them.

Best small-production wineries in Santa Barbara County (priority): 21 answers named other wineries and not you. Cited most in them: nalveauestate.com, the Nalveau Estate site (5 of 21); a wine tour company's site (5 of 21); a national wine magazine (4 of 21); a wine blog (4 of 21). None of those 21 cited your site or a page with your name in its address.

In 9 of those answers the assistant showed what its search returned, and your site was not among the results in any of them. The assistants searched for “best small-production wineries in santa barbara county 2026”, “best small-production wineries in santa barbara county” and “santa barbara county small-production wineries”. Google's AI answers cited another winery's Google Business Profile in 3 of the 6 Google answers here that named others, and yours in none of them.

Best tasting rooms in the Lompoc Wine Ghetto (priority): 20 answers named other wineries and not you. Cited most in them: a trip-planning site (13 of 20), tripadvisor.com (8 of 20), a wine writer's site (7 of 20), a regional wine association site (6 of 20). None of those 20 cited your site or a page with your name in its address.

In 9 of those answers the assistant showed what its search returned, and your site was not among the results in any of them. The assistants searched for “best tasting rooms in the lompoc wine ghetto”, “best tasting rooms in the lompoc wine ghetto for visitors” and “lompoc wine ghetto tasting rooms”. Google's AI answers cited another winery's Google Business Profile in 4 of the 5 Google answers here that named others, and yours in none of them.

Best wineries for a day trip to Santa Barbara wine country (priority): 18 answers named other wineries and not you. Cited most in them: a national wine magazine (5 of 18), a food and travel blog (5 of 18), a sommelier's blog (5 of 18), tripadvisor.com (5 of 18). None of those 18 cited your site or a page with your name in its address.

In 7 of those answers the assistant showed what its search returned, and your site was not among the results in any of them. The assistants searched for “best wineries for a day trip to santa barbara wine country”, “best wineries for a day trip to santa barbara wine country 2026” and “best wineries for a day trip to santa barbara wine country near me”. Google's AI answers cited another winery's Google Business Profile in 2 of the 5 Google answers here that named others, and yours in none of them.

Where to taste Pinot Noir in Santa Barbara County (priority): 21 answers named other wineries and not you. Cited most in them: a wine critic's site (6 of 21), a wine club review site (5 of 21), a regional wine association site (4 of 21), a travel listings site (4 of 21). None of those 21 cited your site or a page with your name in its address.

In 9 of those answers the assistant showed what its search returned, and your site was not among the results in any of them. The assistants searched for “where to taste pinot noir in santa barbara county”, “santa barbara county where to taste pinot noir” and “santa barbara county where to taste pinot noir guide”. Google's AI answers cited another winery's Google Business Profile in 3 of the 6 Google answers here that named others, and yours in none of them.

Where the points are

Measure	Category	You	Best peer	Link to AI	Where the fix lives	This month
Named on best-of lists	Third-Party Presence	29% of the full mark	Brugello Estate 71% of the full mark	strong	off your site (months)	Last month's move, still open
Map-pack presence	Search & Map Discovery	0%	Brugello Estate 23%	strong	off your site (months)	Last month's move, still open
Yelp review count	Review Volume & Reputation	148	Aurelda Family Wines 338	strong	off your site (months)	Move 1
Reviews in the last 90 days	Review Volume & Reputation	0	Brugello Estate 11	strong	off your site (months)	Move 3
Google review count	Review Volume & Reputation	51	Brugello Estate 177	strong	off your site (months)	
Regional tourism and trade directories	Third-Party Presence	50%	Aurelda Family Wines and Dagena Family Wines 100%	moderate	off your site (months)	
Instagram followers	Social	1,937	Dagena Family Wines 13,501	strong	off your site (months)	
Tasting fee published on a tasting page	AI-Ready Booking & Buying	no	Aurelda Family Wines and Bentova Cellars yes	weak	your site (weeks)	
Google secondary categories	Profile Accuracy	0	Bentova Cellars 3	moderate	a profile (days)	
TripAdvisor review count	Review Volume & Reputation	29	Aurelda Family Wines 86	strong	off your site (months)	

Top 10 of 14 gaps.

Three moves this month

These moves follow how Brimova Cellars sells: walk-ins welcome; more visitors and buyers as the goal; and sales through the tasting room, the club, and restaurants and shops. If that is not right, or it changes, tell me and the next report's moves will follow.

Move 1. Close the gap on Yelp review count, in Review Volume & Reputation: you 148, Aurelda Family Wines 338. Why this one: your third-largest gap to the peer set once weighted by its strong link to AI naming. Yelp asks businesses not to request reviews, so the work there is a complete, easy-to-find listing and an answer to every review you get. Larger gaps are not moves this month: your place on best-of lists and map-pack presence are last month's moves, still open. Effort: a campaign; expect months, not weeks.

Move 2, for "Best small-production wineries in Santa Barbara County". Get onto a wine tour company's site. It was cited in 5 of the 21 answers that named other wineries and not you; the page cited most was one article on that site. If the site charges for a listing, take it only where it is clearly marked as sponsored. Why this one: the sources cited for this question point here, and you are named in 0 of 21 answers (0%). Effort: a request or pitch to the site; expect months, not weeks.

Move 3. Close the gap on reviews in the last 90 days, in Review Volume & Reputation: you 0, Brugello Estate 11. Why this one: your fourth-largest gap to the peer set once weighted by its strong link to AI naming. Ask every guest the same way, and offer nothing in return for a review. Effort: a campaign; expect months, not weeks.

Last month's moves

The moves in your Monitor Plus, September 2026 report, sent October 14, 2026, checked against this month's reading.

Move	Status	Evidence	After
Close the gap on your place on best-of lists, in Third-Party Presence: you 29% of the full mark, Brugello Estate 57% of the full mark	Not yet	No change in your standing on this measure.	No question targeted.
Get brimovacellars.com found for the searches the assistants ran for this question: “best high-end seated tastings in santa barbara county”, “santa barbara county high-end seated tastings guide”, “top high-end seated tastings in santa barbara county 2026”	Not yet	This month the assistants' searches returned your site in 0 of 9 answers that showed what they returned (0 of 9 when this was sent).	No clear change: 1 of 20 (5%), from 0 of 18 (0%)
Close the gap on map-pack presence, in Search & Map Discovery: you 0%, Brugello Estate 23%	Not yet	No change in your standing on this measure.	No question targeted.

Basics check

Check	September 2026	October 2026	Status
Google hours complete	no	no	Still missing
Google profile booking link	no	no	Still missing
Shipping cost shown before checkout	no	no	Still missing

Held steady: Google Business Profile found; Google Business Profile claimed; Google profile links your website; Apple Maps listing found; Website reachable; Online reservations on your site; Online store; Club page; Ships direct; Phone on your site matches your listings; Google rating; Google review count; Yelp review count; TripAdvisor review count; Homepage structured data: name; Homepage structured data: opening hours.

Appendix: method and category links

Answers. Each of your questions was put to ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Google AI Mode, Google AI Overviews, Microsoft Copilot and Perplexity in up to 3 rounds between October 10, 2026 and November 3, 2026. 7 runs returned no usable answer (Google AI Overviews: 7 where Google showed no AI Overview for that search) and are left out of every denominator.

ChatGPT returned no sources on 2 of 45 answers. Gemini returned no sources on 9 of 45 answers. Google AI Mode returned no sources on 1 of 45 answers. Google AI Overviews returned no sources on 1 of 38 answers. Google AI Overviews showed some sources by site name only, without the address, on 7 of 38 answers. Those count as sources, but never as a winery's own site, so own-site citations there may read low.

Scoring and links

Scoring. Rubric v3.2, 100 points across 7 categories, scored on every active winery we track (442 this month).

Category links to AI naming

Category	Link to AI
Third-Party Presence	strong
Review Volume & Reputation	strong
Search & Map Discovery	strong
AI-Ready Booking & Buying	moderate
Profile Accuracy	moderate
Citation Readiness	weak
Social	strong

How to read this report

These explanations are the same every month, so they sit here rather than in the body. Anything that changed this month is said where it applies.

You and your peer set. The peer-set table scores every winery the same way on the same day, out of the same points across the same categories. Its last column is how often the AI assistants named each winery when asked about wineries in your county that month. Each category column shows points earned; its maximum is in the column heading. Rank in county counts only wineries with enough measures read to publish a score.

Since last month. The since-last-month table covers your Google reviews, rating and listing checks. A measure is compared only where we read it the same way both months, on the same Google listing. Typical is the middle value. A change of one or two reviews in a month is ordinary.

Drift Watch. Five things we watch every month, and whether any of them moved against you since last month. An alert fires only on a change we measured both months. How often AI assistants name you is kept out of the score. It is the result we are all working toward, so we measure it on its own, in the AI section of this report.

The 7 categories, one by one. Third-Party Presence: do the lists, guides, and press that visitors and AI assistants read name you? Review Volume & Reputation: how many people vouch for you, and are they still doing it? Search & Map Discovery: when a visitor searches for wineries rather than for you by name, do you come up, in the results and on the map? AI-Ready Booking & Buying: once someone has picked you, can they book, join, and buy without picking up the phone? Profile Accuracy: does your Google profile state the right facts, and does Apple Maps agree? Citation Readiness: when a search engine or AI assistant reads your site, can it get the facts out? Social: does your Instagram confirm you're open, active, and worth visiting? Each category's link to being named by AI assistants, across every winery we score, is in the appendix table of category links. A link like this is a pattern across wineries, not proof of cause; the months ahead will show whether raising a score brings more mentions.

Your AI questions. An answer is one assistant's reply to one question in one round of asking. Named means your winery appears anywhere in the reply. A question counts as won when you are named in at least half of its answers. The table by assistant shows how often each assistant named you, the wineries it named most and the sources it cited most. Counts are answers (an answer naming a winery or citing a site counts once). Your own site is included among the sources. A question marked (priority) is one of your priority questions. A question can favor other wineries by where it is set or by what it asks for. A question is listed here when you were named in a quarter of its answers or fewer, one other winery was named in at least half, and the question names a place your tasting room is not in or asks for something we do not have on file as an offer of yours.

The citation gap: what the assistants cited instead. For each priority question, the sources the assistants cited most. Where you are not winning, we read the answers that named other wineries and not you; where you are, the answers that named you. What we measured is which addresses were cited; whether a source mentions you on a page we did not see is not measured.

Where the points are. Every measure where a peer scores ahead of you, ranked by what closing the gap is worth and by how strongly that measure goes with being named by AI assistants. Where the fix lives: a fix on your site moves in weeks; on a platform profile, in days; off your site (reviews, press, lists), it takes a campaign over months. The column headed This month says whether a gap is one of this month's moves, last month's move still open, or not advised; a blank is a gap ranked below this month's moves. Yelp asks businesses not to request reviews; that count tends to follow guest volume and a complete listing rather than asking.

Last month's moves. Each move is checked against this month's reading; movement is reported as what happened after the move was sent, never as its cause.

Basics check. This lists only what broke, changed or could not be read since last month, checked the same way both months.

Appendix: method and category links. A winery is named when we find its name, an alias or its domain in the reply. Shares are answers naming you over all answers to that question, every assistant pooled. AI answers vary from round to round. The spread is the gap between the highest and lowest round. A month-on-month move smaller than the spread is reported as no clear change. The sources are the addresses each assistant returned with its answer. For each category and measure, the link to AI naming is how closely the points a winery earns rank with the share of its own county's AI answers that name it, across every winery we score, graded strong, moderate, weak or none.

If you want to go further on any of these moves, I'm glad to work through them with you on a call: book a time at calendly.com/scott_mainstreetiq/30min, or write to me at scott@mainstreetiq.com.